

Applied Physics Lab Handbook

Complete professional laboratory textbook for Course Code 2006. This lesson is built from the supplied official syllabus and converts the experiment list into a practical learning, revision, viva and exam-preparation handbook.

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COURSE CODE

2006

TITLE

Applied Physics Lab

SEMESTER

1 & 2

CREDITS

1

CATEGORY

Basic Science

PERIODS

2/week

SEMESTER PERIODS

30 + 30

SCHEME

Revision 2021

Measure → Correct → Calculate → Verify → Report

Every practical answer must show aim, apparatus, principle, formula, diagram/circuit, procedure, observation table, calculation, result, precautions and common errors.

20 experiments

4 CO modules

12 minimum experiments to perform

__SVG_MEASURE__

Course Overview

Applied Physics Lab develops measurement discipline, apparatus handling confidence and engineering interpretation of physics experiments.

Objectives from supplied syllabus

- Supplement factual physics knowledge by first-hand manipulation of apparatus.
- Develop scientific temper for applying physics principles to engineering and technology problems.
- Build confidence in equipment handling and measurement skills.

Prerequisite

Basic knowledge in Physics from Secondary School.

□ lab subject-□ theory □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□. Instrument □□□□□□□□□□, least count □□□□□□□□□□, graph □□□□□□□□□□, result unit □□□□□□ □□□□□□ practice □□□□.

Table of Contents

Official source information

Item	Status	Value from supplied syllabus/source
Course code/title	Specified	2006 - Applied Physics Lab
Programme	Specified	Diploma in Engineering and Technology
Semester	Specified	1 & 2
Credits/category	Specified	1 credit, Basic Science
Periods	Specified	2 per week; 30 + 30 per semester
CO-PO mapping	Specified	CO1, CO2, CO3 and CO4 mapped to PO1 at level 3. Other PO values are blank/not specified.
Exam blueprint	Limited	Lab Exam I and II are mentioned; detailed written question-paper pattern is not specified in supplied source. Model paper here is a fresh practice paper.

Redesigned Syllabus Roadmap

Not a copied syllabus table. This roadmap tells what to draw, calculate, explain and avoid in each module.

Module 1 • 12 hours • CO1

Measurement Tools and Accuracy

Outcome: Select appropriate measuring tools and make measurements with accuracy and precision.

Core topics: Vernier calipers, Screw gauge, Spherometer, Mercury thermometer, Least count, Zero error, Unit conversion

What to draw: Vernier jaws and scales, Screw gauge pitch/head scale, Spherometer legs and screw, Temperature scale conversion

What to calculate: least count, zero correction, volume, diameter/thickness, radius of curvature, temperature conversion

Field relevance: Reading accuracy, zero correction, graph plotting, connection checking and troubleshooting are the same habits needed in workshop testing, electrical panels, sensors and maintenance measurements.

Module 2 • 23 hours • CO2

Mechanics and Properties of Matter

Outcome: Apply and illustrate mechanics and properties of matter through experiments.

Core topics: Hooke law, Stoke law, Parallelogram law, Moment bar, U-tube, Flywheel, Pendulum, Resonance column, Cantilever

What to draw: spring graph, terminal velocity setup, vector force diagram, moment bar, U-tube levels, flywheel, pendulum, resonance column, cantilever

What to calculate: spring constant, viscosity, unknown mass, moment balance, relative density, moment of inertia, g, sound velocity, time period

Field relevance: Reading accuracy, zero correction, graph plotting, connection checking and troubleshooting are the same habits needed in workshop testing, electrical panels, sensors and maintenance measurements.

Module 3 • 6 hours • CO3

Ray Optics Experiments

Outcome: Experiment with lens, prism and glass slab to realize basic laws of ray optics.

Core topics: Convex lens u-v method, Lens power, Refraction, Snell law, Ray tracing

What to draw: u-v setup, convex lens ray diagram, glass slab/prism ray diagram

What to calculate: focal length, power, $\sin i / \sin r$, refractive index

Field relevance: Reading accuracy, zero correction, graph plotting, connection checking and troubleshooting are the same habits needed in workshop testing, electrical panels, sensors and maintenance measurements.

Module 4 • 15 hours • CO4

Electrical and Semiconductor Characteristics

Outcome: Use V-I characteristics of conductors and semiconductors to determine resistance of materials.

Core topics: Ohm law, series/parallel resistance, diode V-I, potentiometer, meter bridge, specific resistance

What to draw: ammeter-voltmeter circuit, series/parallel circuits, diode V-I graph, potentiometer circuit, meter bridge

What to calculate: $R = V/I$, equivalent resistance, knee voltage, internal resistance, specific resistance

Field relevance: Reading accuracy, zero correction, graph plotting, connection checking and troubleshooting are the same habits needed in workshop testing, electrical panels, sensors and maintenance measurements.

Module 1

Module 1 • CO1 • 12 hours

Measurement Tools and Accuracy

Select appropriate measuring tools and make measurements with accuracy and precision.

Chapter introduction

This chapter converts the laboratory outcome into student-friendly experiments. Study principle first, then procedure, readings, formula, result and precautions.

Module checklist

- Core topics: Vernier calipers, Screw gauge, Spherometer, Mercury thermometer, Least count, Zero error, Unit conversion
- Draw: Vernier jaws and scales, Screw gauge pitch/head scale, Spherometer legs and screw, Temperature scale conversion
- Calculate: least count, zero correction, volume, diameter/thickness, radius of curvature, temperature conversion
- Common mistake: skipping unit, zero correction, graph scale or polarity check.

Experiment 1

Vernier Calipers

Aim: Determine volume of spherical/cylindrical body and test tube using Vernier calipers.

Apparatus: Vernier calipers, sphere/cylinder, test tube.

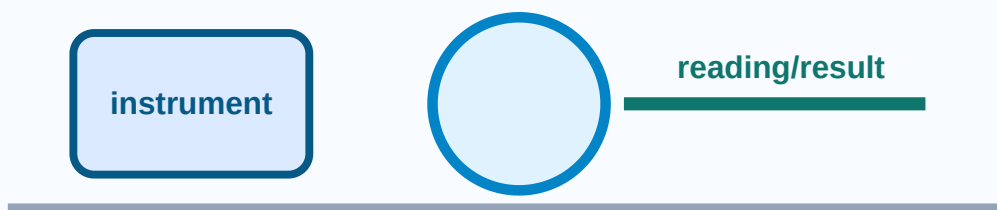
Principle: Vernier scale improves length measurement; least count is the smallest measurable length.

Formula/rule: $LC = 1 \text{ MSD} - 1 \text{ VSD}$; sphere $V = \frac{4}{3} \pi r^3$; cylinder $V = \pi r^2 h$

Procedure

- 1 Check zero error and zero correction.
- 2 Hold object gently between jaws.
- 3 Read main scale just before Vernier zero.
- 4 Find coinciding Vernier division.
- 5 Calculate corrected dimension and volume.

Vernier Calipers experiment diagram



Observation table columns: Object | MSR | Vernier coincidence | LC | Corrected dimension | Volume

Precautions: Avoid parallax.; Do not overtighten jaws.; Use consistent units.

Common fault: Ignoring zero correction gives wrong result.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ്, യൂണിറ്റ്, ഓരോ നിരയും ശ്രദ്ധയോടെ എഴുതണം. റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോസ് കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവറോഡ് ചെയ്യലുകൾ തടയണം.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 2

Screw Gauge

Aim: Determine diameter of wire/ball and thickness of glass plate.

Apparatus: Screw gauge, wire, ball, glass plate.

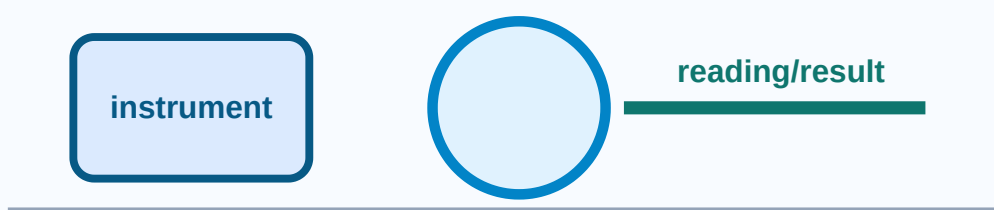
Principle: A screw converts rotation into small linear movement for fine measurement.

Formula/rule: $LC = \text{pitch} / \text{circular divisions}$; reading = PSR + CSR x LC +/- zero correction

Procedure

- 1 Find pitch and least count.
- 2 Check zero error.
- 3 Place object between anvil and spindle.
- 4 Use ratchet gently.
- 5 Take readings at different positions.

Screw Gauge experiment diagram



Observation table columns: Trial | PSR | CSR | LC | Zero correction | Corrected reading

Precautions: Use ratchet only.; Keep wire perpendicular.; Avoid compression.

Common fault: Overtightening makes reading smaller.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, പൂജ്യം തെറ്റും, യൂണിറ്റ് പരിവർത്തനം, നിരീക്ഷണ വൃത്തിയുടെ ഏറ്റവും ഉയർന്ന മൂല്യം. വായനയിലെ പാരലാക്സ്, അലിയിക്കൽ, ഓവർലോഡ് തെറ്റുകൾ ഒഴിവാക്കുക.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 3

Spherometer

Aim: Determine radius of curvature of spherical surface.

Apparatus: Spherometer, spherical surface, plane glass, scale.

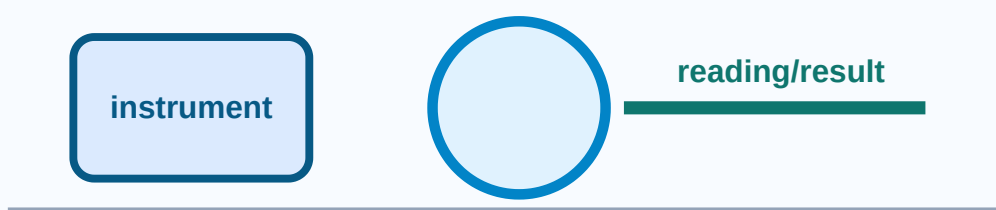
Principle: Sagitta h is measured with central screw and radius is calculated from leg spacing.

Formula/rule: $R = l^2/(6h) + h/2$

Procedure

- 1 Find least count.
- 2 Take plane glass reading.
- 3 Take spherical surface reading.
- 4 Measure distances between legs.
- 5 Calculate h and R .

Spherometer experiment diagram



Observation table columns: l1 | l2 | l3 | mean l | h | R

Precautions: All legs must touch surface.; Do not drag on optical surface.; Use correct sign.

Common fault: Wrong sign of h is common.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാർലാക്സ്, ലോസ്റ്റ് കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാർലാക്സ്, ലോസ്റ്റ് കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാർലാക്സ്. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാർലാക്സ്, ലോസ്റ്റ് കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാർലാക്സ്.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 4

Mercury Thermometer

Aim: Measure room and hot bath temperature and convert scales.

Apparatus: Mercury thermometer, hot bath, beaker, stirrer.

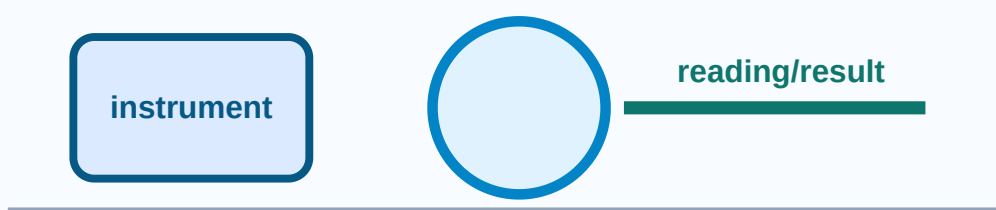
Principle: Mercury expansion indicates temperature.

Formula/rule: $K = C + 273$; $F = \frac{9C}{5} + 32$

Procedure

- 1 Check range and least count.
- 2 Wait for stable reading.
- 3 Immerse bulb without touching bottom.
- 4 Read at eye level.
- 5 Convert scales.

Mercury Thermometer experiment diagram



Observation table columns: Condition | Celsius | Kelvin | Fahrenheit | Remarks

Precautions: Do not hold bulb.; Do not hit glass.; Read at eye level.

Common fault: Bulb touching beaker wall changes reading.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Module 1 Expected Questions

Vernier Calipers: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Screw Gauge: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Spherometer: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Mercury Thermometer: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Module 2

Module 2 • CO2 • 23 hours

Mechanics and Properties of Matter

Apply and illustrate mechanics and properties of matter through experiments.

Chapter introduction

This chapter converts the laboratory outcome into student-friendly experiments. Study principle first, then procedure, readings, formula, result and precautions.

Module checklist

- Core topics: Hooke law, Stoke law, Parallelogram law, Moment bar, U-tube, Flywheel, Pendulum, Resonance column, Cantilever
- Draw: spring graph, terminal velocity setup, vector force diagram, moment bar, U-tube levels, flywheel, pendulum, resonance column, cantilever
- Calculate: spring constant, viscosity, unknown mass, moment balance, relative density, moment of inertia, g , sound velocity, time period
- Common mistake: skipping unit, zero correction, graph scale or polarity check.

Experiment 5

Hooke Law

Aim: Verify Hooke law and find force constant of spring.

Apparatus: Spring, weights, pointer, scale.

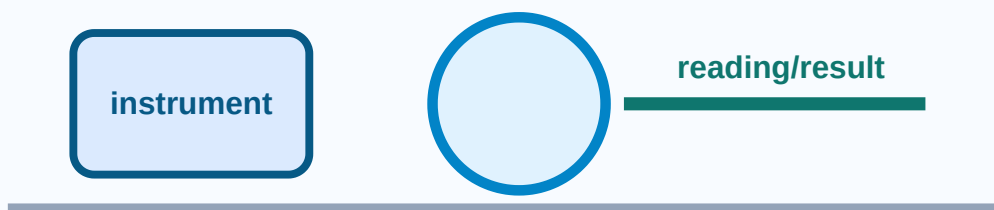
Principle: Within elastic limit extension is proportional to load.

Formula/rule: $F = kx$; $k = F/x$

Procedure

- 1 Note initial reading.
- 2 Add weights gradually.
- 3 Record extension.
- 4 Plot load-extension graph.
- 5 Find slope k .

Hooke Law experiment diagram



Observation table columns: Load | Force | Reading | Extension | k

Precautions: Do not cross elastic limit.; Wait until oscillation stops.; Load gently.

Common fault: Nonlinear graph means elastic limit crossed.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 6

Stoke Law

Aim: Find viscosity using terminal velocity of a falling sphere.

Apparatus: Tall jar, liquid, sphere, stopwatch, scale.

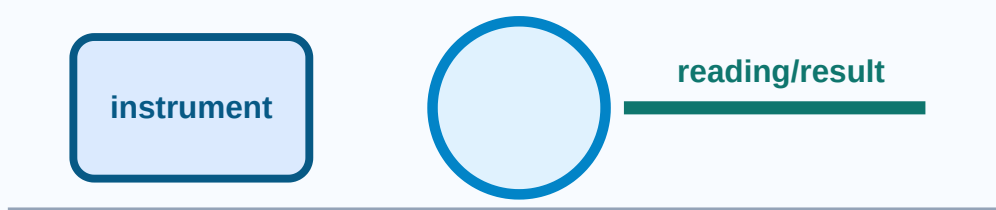
Principle: At terminal velocity, weight is balanced by buoyancy and viscous force.

Formula/rule: $\eta = \frac{2r^2(\rho_s - \rho_l)g}{9v}$

Procedure

- 1 Measure sphere radius.
- 2 Mark terminal region.
- 3 Drop sphere centrally.
- 4 Time known distance.
- 5 Calculate velocity and viscosity.

Stoke Law experiment diagram



Observation table columns: radius | distance | time | velocity | density | viscosity

Precautions: Avoid bubbles.; Sphere must fall centrally.; Use terminal region.

Common fault: Timing immediately after release is wrong.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത ഏറ്റവും കൂടുതൽ. റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 7

Parallelogram Law

Aim: Verify force law and find unknown mass.

Apparatus: Force board/table, pulleys, weights.

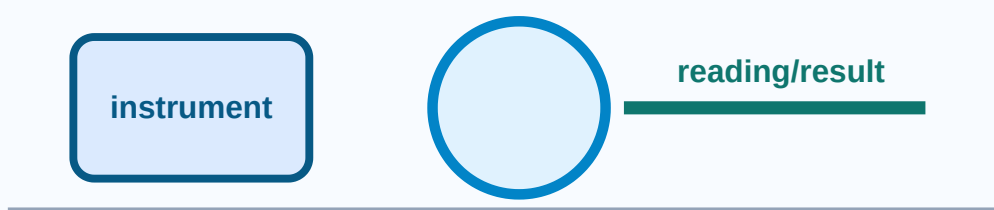
Principle: Two forces can be represented by adjacent sides of a parallelogram; diagonal gives resultant.

Formula/rule: $R = \sqrt{P^2 + Q^2 + 2PQ \cos \theta}$

Procedure

- 1 Set two known weights.
- 2 Adjust third for equilibrium.
- 3 Mark string directions.
- 4 Draw parallelogram to scale.
- 5 Compare resultant with balancing weight.

Parallelogram Law experiment diagram



Observation table columns: P | Q | theta | R | balancing mass

Precautions: Pulleys friction-free.; Strings must meet at one point.; Use correct scale.

Common fault: Bad scale drawing gives wrong mass.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് മിസ്റ്റേക്ക്.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 8

Moment Bar

Aim: Find mass using principle of moments.

Apparatus: Moment bar, knife edge, weights.

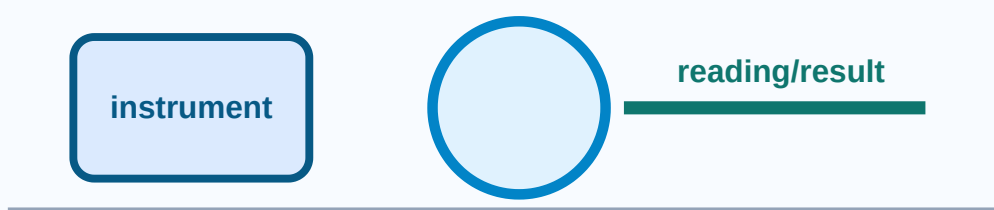
Principle: At equilibrium clockwise moment equals anticlockwise moment.

Formula/rule: $W_1 d_1 = W_2 d_2$

Procedure

- 1 Balance empty bar.
- 2 Place known weight.
- 3 Place unknown body.
- 4 Adjust distances for balance.
- 5 Calculate mass.

Moment Bar experiment diagram



Observation table columns: known mass | distance | unknown distance | unknown mass

Precautions: Measure from pivot.; Keep knife edge sharp.; Avoid oscillation.

Common fault: Measuring from wrong zero causes error.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, zero error, unit conversion, observation neatness ശ്രദ്ധിക്കുക. Reading പാരലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 9

U-tube Apparatus

Aim: Find relative density of liquid.

Apparatus: U-tube, liquids, scale.

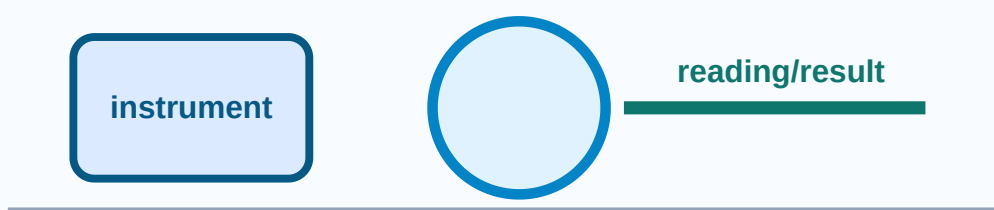
Principle: Pressure at same horizontal level in connected liquid columns is equal.

Formula/rule: $\rho_1 h_1 = \rho_2 h_2$

Procedure

- 1 Pour reference liquid.
- 2 Add test liquid.
- 3 Allow levels to settle.
- 4 Measure heights.
- 5 Calculate relative density.

U-tube Apparatus experiment diagram



Observation table columns: liquid | h1 | h2 | relative density

Precautions: Avoid bubbles.; Read meniscus correctly.; Tube vertical.

Common fault: Wrong meniscus level gives error.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം, റീഡിംഗ് കൃത്യത, റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം, loose contact, overload ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട് mistakes ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 10

Flywheel

Aim: Find moment of inertia of a flywheel.

Apparatus: Flywheel, axle, thread, mass, stopwatch.

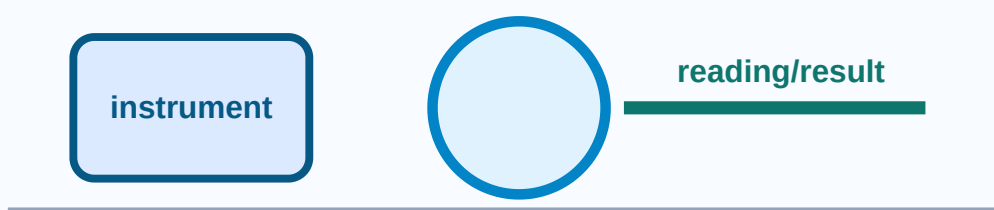
Principle: Falling mass energy changes into rotational kinetic energy and friction losses.

Formula/rule: I from energy balance using mass, height, rotations and omega

Procedure

- 1 Wind thread uniformly.
- 2 Attach mass and release.
- 3 Count rotations.
- 4 Measure fall time and height.
- 5 Calculate I.

Flywheel experiment diagram



Observation table columns: mass | height | time | rotations | l

Precautions: No thread overlap.; Count rotations carefully.; Release without push.

Common fault: Missing free rotations causes wrong friction correction.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത, റീഡിംഗ് പരിഭ്രംശം. Reading parallax, loose contact, overload mistakes.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 11

Simple Pendulum

Aim: Find acceleration due to gravity.

Apparatus: Pendulum bob, thread, stand, stopwatch, scale.

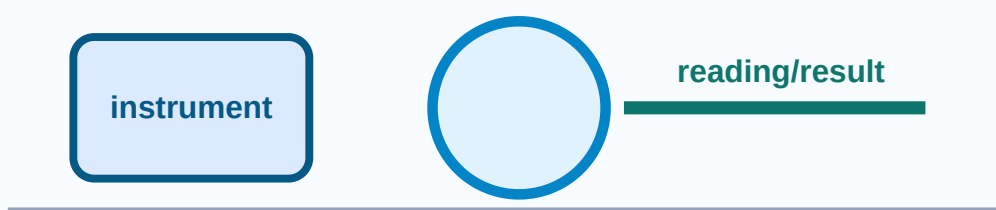
Principle: For small oscillations time period depends on length and g.

Formula/rule: $T = 2\pi \sqrt{l/g}$; $g = 4\pi^2 l / T^2$

Procedure

- 1 Measure effective length.
- 2 Give small displacement.
- 3 Record time for 20 oscillations.
- 4 Repeat for different lengths.
- 5 Calculate T and g.

Simple Pendulum experiment diagram



Observation table columns: length | time for 20 | T | g

Precautions: Small amplitude.; Avoid elliptical motion.; Same reference point.

Common fault: Using string length instead of effective length.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, zero error, unit conversion, observation neatness ഏറ്റവും കൃത്യമായി. Reading പാരലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload ഏറ്റവും കൃത്യമായി mistakes ഏറ്റവും കൃത്യമായി.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 12

Resonance Column

Aim: Find velocity of sound in air.

Apparatus: Resonance column, tuning fork, thermometer.

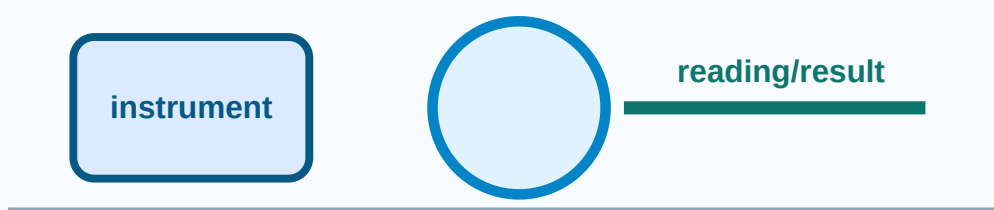
Principle: Air column resonates at odd-quarter wavelength lengths.

Formula/rule: $v = 2f(l_2 - l_1)$

Procedure

- 1 Strike fork gently.
- 2 Hold near tube.
- 3 Adjust water level.
- 4 Find first and second resonance.
- 5 Calculate velocity.

Resonance Column experiment diagram



Observation table columns: frequency | l1 | l2 | temperature | v

Precautions: Do not touch fork.; Use same fork position.; Read water level at eye level.

Common fault: Ignoring end correction can reduce accuracy.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പരാലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ് പരാലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 13

Cantilever

Aim: Find and verify time period of oscillation.

Apparatus: Cantilever strip, load, stopwatch.

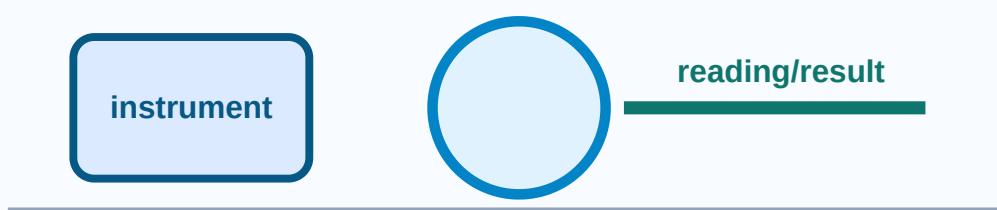
Principle: A loaded cantilever performs oscillation depending on load and stiffness.

Formula/rule: T depends on effective mass and stiffness

Procedure

- 1 Clamp one end firmly.
- 2 Attach load at free end.
- 3 Displace slightly.
- 4 Measure time for oscillations.
- 5 Compare time periods.

Cantilever experiment diagram



Observation table columns: load | length | time | T

Precautions: Clamp rigidly.; Small oscillation only.; Avoid air disturbance.

Common fault: Loose clamp changes result.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, zero error, unit conversion, observation neatness ശ്രദ്ധിക്കുക. Reading പാരലാക്സ്, loose contact, overload താഴെ പറയുന്ന ത্রുടികൾ ശ്രദ്ധിക്കുക.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Module 2 Expected Questions

Hooke Law: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Stoke Law: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Parallelogram Law: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Moment Bar: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

U-tube Apparatus: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Flywheel: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Simple Pendulum: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Resonance Column: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Cantilever: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Module 3

Module 3 • CO3 • 6 hours

Ray Optics Experiments

Experiment with lens, prism and glass slab to realize basic laws of ray optics.

Chapter introduction

This chapter converts the laboratory outcome into student-friendly experiments. Study principle first, then procedure, readings, formula, result and precautions.

Module checklist

- Core topics: Convex lens u-v method, Lens power, Refraction, Snell law, Ray tracing
- Draw: u-v setup, convex lens ray diagram, glass slab/prism ray diagram
- Calculate: focal length, power, $\sin i/\sin r$, refractive index
- Common mistake: skipping unit, zero correction, graph scale or polarity check.

Experiment 14

Convex Lens

Aim: Find focal length and power by u-v method.

Apparatus: Optical bench, convex lens, object, screen.

Principle: Lens equation relates object distance, image distance and focal length.

Formula/rule: $1/f = 1/u + 1/v$; $P = 1/f$ metre

Procedure

1 Align object lens and screen.

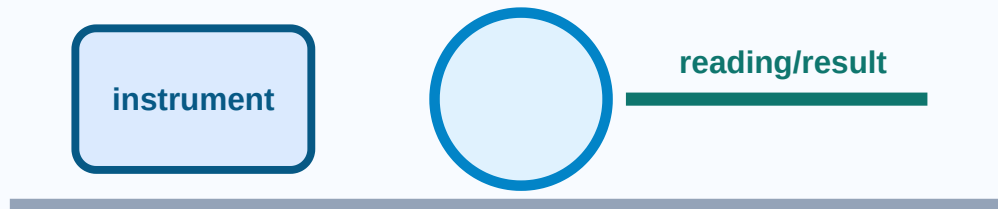
2 Find sharp image.

3 Record u and v.

4 Repeat.

5 Calculate f and power.

Convex Lens experiment diagram



Observation table columns: u | v | f | P

Precautions: Same height.; Use sharp image.; Avoid parallax.

Common fault: Sign convention confusion.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത, ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്, loose contact, overload ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 15

Snell Law

Aim: Verify Snell law using glass slab/prism.

Apparatus: Glass slab/prism, pins, protractor, scale.

Principle: For two media, $\sin i / \sin r$ is constant.

Formula/rule: $\mu = \sin i / \sin r$

Procedure

1 Trace glass outline.

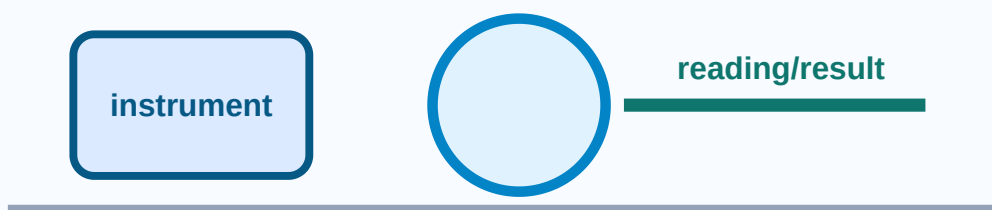
2 Draw normal.

3 Fix incident ray pins.

4 Place emergent ray pins.

5 Measure i and r .

Snell Law experiment diagram



Observation table columns: i | r | $\sin i$ | $\sin r$ | μ

Precautions: Pins vertical.; Wide pin separation.; Draw normal accurately.

Common fault: Wrong normal spoils ray diagram.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത, ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്. Reading പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് മിസ്റ്റേക്ക്.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Module 3 Expected Questions

Convex Lens: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Snell Law: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Module 4

Module 4 • CO4 • 15 hours

Electrical and Semiconductor Characteristics

Use V-I characteristics of conductors and semiconductors to determine resistance of materials.

Chapter introduction

This chapter converts the laboratory outcome into student-friendly experiments. Study principle first, then procedure, readings, formula, result and precautions.

Module checklist

- Core topics: Ohm law, series/parallel resistance, diode V-I, potentiometer, meter bridge, specific resistance
- Draw: ammeter-voltmeter circuit, series/parallel circuits, diode V-I graph, potentiometer circuit, meter bridge
- Calculate: $R=V/I$, equivalent resistance, knee voltage, internal resistance, specific resistance
- Common mistake: skipping unit, zero correction, graph scale or polarity check.

Experiment 16

Ohm Law

Aim: Verify Ohm law by V-I graph.

Apparatus: DC supply, resistor, ammeter, voltmeter, rheostat.

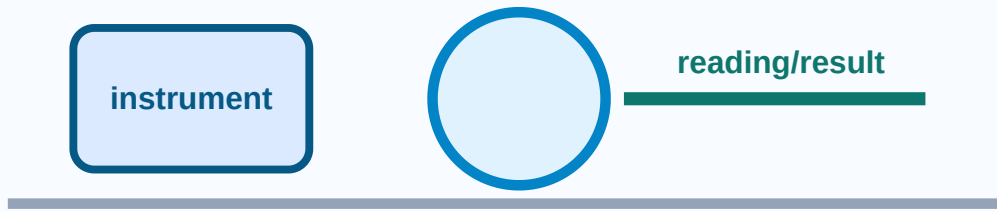
Principle: At constant temperature current is proportional to voltage.

Formula/rule: $V = IR$; $R = V/I$

Procedure

- 1 Connect ammeter in series.
- 2 Connect voltmeter across resistor.
- 3 Vary rheostat.
- 4 Record V and I.
- 5 Plot graph and find slope.

Ohm Law experiment diagram



Observation table columns: V | I | R | slope

Precautions: Check polarity.; Avoid heating.; Use proper range.

Common fault: Loose contacts fluctuate current.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, ശുദ്ധത, യൂണിറ്റ് പരിവർത്തനം, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത പരസ്പരം. Reading പരസ്പരം parallax, loose contact, overload പരസ്പരം mistakes പരസ്പരം.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 17

Laws of Resistances

Aim: Verify series and parallel laws.

Apparatus: Resistors, supply, meters, wires.

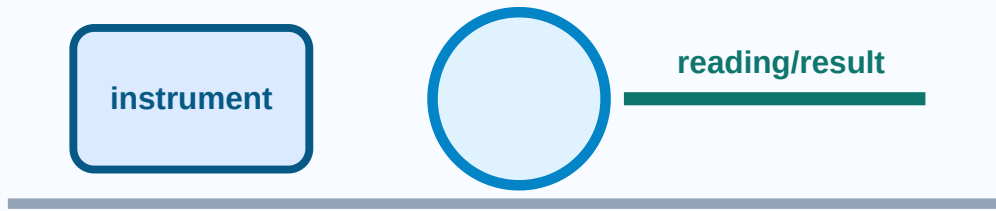
Principle: Series resistances add; in parallel reciprocals add.

Formula/rule: $R_s = R_1 + R_2$; $1/R_p = 1/R_1 + 1/R_2$

Procedure

- 1 Measure individual resistances.
- 2 Connect series and observe equivalent.
- 3 Connect parallel and observe equivalent.
- 4 Compare with theory.
- 5 Find error.

Laws of Resistances experiment diagram



Observation table columns: R1 | R2 | theory | observed | error

Precautions: Correct wiring.; No short circuit.; Proper meter range.

Common fault: Parallel branch often gets shorted.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ്, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 18

Diode V-I Characteristics

Aim: Draw V-I curve and find knee voltage.

Apparatus: Diode, supply, resistor, milliammeter, voltmeter.

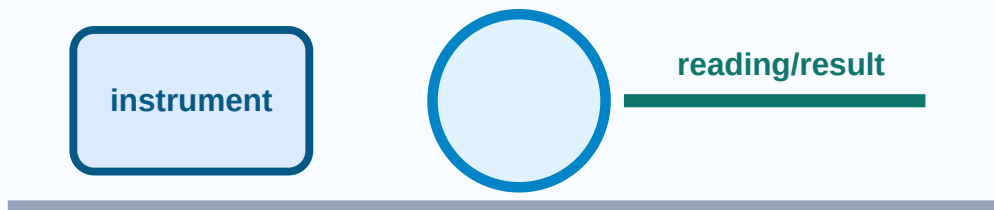
Principle: Diode conducts in forward bias after knee voltage and blocks in reverse bias.

Formula/rule: Ge knee about 0.3 V; Si knee about 0.7 V

Procedure

- 1 Connect forward bias with resistor.
- 2 Increase voltage slowly.
- 3 Record current.
- 4 Plot curve.
- 5 Identify knee voltage.

Diode V-I Characteristics experiment diagram



Observation table columns: V_f | I_f | V_r | I_r | knee voltage

Precautions: Use current limiting resistor.; Do not exceed rating.; Check polarity.

Common fault: Direct connection can destroy diode.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിഴവ്, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത ഏറ്റവും കൂടുതൽ. Reading ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ പിറാലക്സ്, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് ഏറ്റവും കൂടുതൽ മിസ്റ്റേക്ക് ഏറ്റവും കൂടുതൽ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 19

Potentiometer

Aim: Find internal resistance/comparison of emfs.

Apparatus: Potentiometer, cells, galvanometer, jockey.

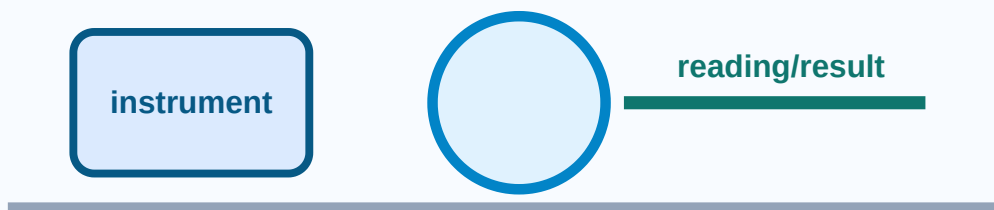
Principle: Potential drop along uniform wire is proportional to length at balance.

Formula/rule: $E_1/E_2 = l_1/l_2$; $r = R(l_1 - l_2)/l_2$

Procedure

- 1 Set primary circuit.
- 2 Find balance length open cell.
- 3 Connect external R and find new length.
- 4 Calculate r .
- 5 Compare emfs using lengths.

Potentiometer experiment diagram



Observation table columns: cell | I₁ | I₂ | R | r/emf ratio

Precautions: Do not drag jockey.; Driver emf must be higher.; Check polarity.

Common fault: Wrong polarity gives no balance.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ്, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Experiment 20

Meter Bridge

Aim: Find specific resistance of wire.

Apparatus: Meter bridge, resistance box, galvanometer, wire.

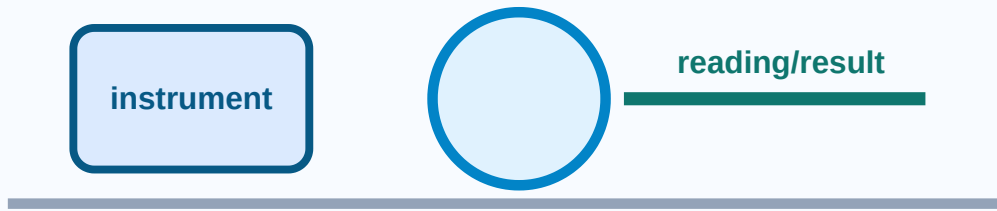
Principle: At Wheatstone bridge balance, ratio of resistances equals ratio of wire lengths.

Formula/rule: $X/R = l/(100-l)$; $\rho = RA/L$

Procedure

- 1 Connect unknown and resistance box.
- 2 Find null point.
- 3 Interchange gaps.
- 4 Measure wire length and diameter.
- 5 Calculate ρ .

Meter Bridge experiment diagram



Observation table columns: R | l | X | L | d | rho

Precautions: Do not press jockey hard.; Balance near middle.; Remove key when idle.

Common fault: Oxidised contact causes wrong balance.

Malayalam support: Experiment result ഏറ്റവും കുറഞ്ഞ കൗണ്ട്, റീഡിംഗ്, യൂണിറ്റ് കൺവേർഷൻ, നിരീക്ഷണ ശുദ്ധത, റീഡിംഗ് പാരലാക്സ്, ലോose കൺടാക്ട്, ഓവർലോഡ് തെറ്റുകൾ.

Exam answer format: Aim → apparatus → labelled diagram/circuit → principle → formula → procedure → observation table → calculation → result with unit → precautions.

Module 4 Expected Questions

Ohm Law: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Laws of Resistances: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Diode V-I Characteristics: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Potentiometer: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Meter Bridge: Write aim, draw labelled setup/circuit, explain principle, derive/apply formula, prepare observation table, list precautions and mention one troubleshooting fault.

Formula / Rule Bank

Formula, variable meaning, unit and use. For lab exams, write formula before substitution and final result with unit.

Vernier LC

$$LC = 1 \text{ MSD} - 1 \text{ VSD}$$

Unit: mm/cm

Use: smallest Vernier reading

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Screw gauge LC

$$LC = \text{pitch} / \text{circular divisions}$$

Unit: mm

Use: fine thickness/diameter

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Sphere volume

$$V = \frac{4}{3} \pi r^3$$

Unit: cm³

Use: sphere volume

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Cylinder volume

$$V = \pi r^2 h$$

Unit: cm³

Use: cylinder/test tube

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Spherometer

$$R = \frac{l^2}{(6h)} + \frac{h}{2}$$

Unit: cm

Use: radius of curvature

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Temperature

$$K=C+273; F=9C/5+32$$

Unit: K/F

Use: scale conversion

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Hooke law

$$F=kx$$

Unit: N/m

Use: spring constant

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Stoke law

$$\eta=2r^2(\rho_{\text{os}}-\rho_{\text{ol}})g/(9v)$$

Unit: Pa s

Use: viscosity

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Moment

$$W_1d_1=W_2d_2$$

Unit: N m

Use: moment bar

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Pendulum

$$g=4\pi^2l/T^2$$

Unit: m/s²

Use: gravity

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Sound

$$v=2f(l_2-l_1)$$

Unit: m/s

Use: resonance column

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Lens

$$1/f=1/u+1/v$$

Unit: m

Use: focal length

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Lens power

$$P=1/f$$

Unit: D

Use: lens power

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Snell

$$\mu=\sin i/\sin r$$

Unit: none

Use: refractive index

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Ohm

$$V=IR$$

Unit: ohm

Use: resistance

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Series R

$$R_s = R_1 + R_2 + \dots$$

Unit: ohm

Use: series circuit

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Parallel R

$$1/R_p = 1/R_1 + 1/R_2$$

Unit: ohm

Use: parallel circuit

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Diode

$$R_f = \Delta V / \Delta I$$

Unit: ohm

Use: V-I curve

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Meter bridge

$$\rho = RA/L$$

Unit: ohm m

Use: specific resistance

Example: Substitute readings with units and write final result correctly.

Practice, Expected Questions and Quick Revision

Module-wise viva, short-answer, numerical, diagram and practical-style questions.

Module 1: Measurement Tools and Accuracy

Short/viva: What is the principle of Vernier Calipers?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $LC = 1 \text{ MSD} - 1 \text{ VSD}$; sphere $V = \frac{4}{3} \pi r^3$; cylinder $V = \pi r^2 h$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Avoid parallax.; Do not overtighten jaws.; Use consistent units..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Screw Gauge?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $LC = \text{pitch} / \text{circular divisions}$; reading = $PSR + CSR \times LC \pm \text{zero correction}$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Use ratchet only.; Keep wire perpendicular.; Avoid compression..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Spherometer?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $R = \frac{l^2}{6h} + \frac{h}{2}$.

Practical: Mention precautions: All legs must touch surface.; Do not drag on optical surface.; Use correct sign..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Mercury Thermometer?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $K = C + 273$; $F = \frac{9C}{5} + 32$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Do not hold bulb.; Do not hit glass.; Read at eye level..

Module 2: Mechanics and Properties of Matter

Short/viva: What is the principle of Hooke Law?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $F = kx$; $k = F/x$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Do not cross elastic limit.; Wait until oscillation stops.; Load gently..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Stoke Law?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $\eta = \frac{2r^2(\rho_{\text{s}} - \rho_{\text{f}})g}{9v}$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Avoid bubbles.; Sphere must fall centrally.; Use terminal region..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Parallelogram Law?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $R = \sqrt{P^2 + Q^2 + 2PQ \cos \theta}$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Pulleys friction-free.; Strings must meet at one point.; Use correct scale..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Moment Bar?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $W_1 d_1 = W_2 d_2$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Measure from pivot.; Keep knife edge sharp.; Avoid oscillation..

Short/viva: What is the principle of U-tube Apparatus?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $\rho_1 h_1 = \rho_2 h_2$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Avoid bubbles.; Read meniscus correctly.; Tube vertical..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Flywheel?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use I from energy balance using mass, height, rotations and ω .

Practical: Mention precautions: No thread overlap.; Count rotations carefully.; Release without push..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Simple Pendulum?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $T = 2\pi \sqrt{l/g}$; $g = 4\pi^2 l / T^2$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Small amplitude.; Avoid elliptical motion.; Same reference point..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Resonance Column?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $v = 2f(l_2 - l_1)$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Do not touch fork.; Use same fork position.; Read water level at eye level..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Cantilever?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use T depends on effective mass and stiffness.

Practical: Mention precautions: Clamp rigidly.; Small oscillation only.; Avoid air disturbance..

Module 3: Ray Optics Experiments

Short/viva: What is the principle of Convex Lens?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $1/f = 1/u + 1/v$; $P = 1/f$ metre.

Practical: Mention precautions: Same height.; Use sharp image.; Avoid parallax..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Snell Law?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $\mu = \sin i / \sin r$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Pins vertical.; Wide pin separation.; Draw normal accurately..

Module 4: Electrical and Semiconductor Characteristics

Short/viva: What is the principle of Ohm Law?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $V = IR$; $R = V/I$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Check polarity.; Avoid heating.; Use proper range..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Laws of Resistances?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $R_s = R_1 + R_2$; $1/R_p = 1/R_1 + 1/R_2$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Correct wiring.; No short circuit.; Proper meter range..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Diode V-I Characteristics?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use Ge knee about 0.3 V; Si knee about 0.7 V.

Practical: Mention precautions: Use current limiting resistor.; Do not exceed rating.; Check polarity..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Potentiometer?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $E_1/E_2 = l_1/l_2$; $r = R(l_1 - l_2)/l_2$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Do not drag jockey.; Driver emf must be higher.; Check polarity..

Short/viva: What is the principle of Meter Bridge?

Diagram: Draw the setup/circuit.

Numerical: Use $X/R = l/(100-l)$; $\rho = RA/L$.

Practical: Mention precautions: Do not press jockey hard.; Balance near middle.; Remove key when idle..

Objective Practice Answer Key

1. Least count means smallest measurable value. **2.** Ohm law graph slope gives resistance. **3.** Meter bridge is based on Wheatstone bridge. **4.** Snell law gives refractive index. **5.** Diode knee voltage is read from forward V-I curve.

Fresh Model Question Paper

Prepared for practice from the supplied syllabus. It does not copy official questions.

Time: 3 Hours **Maximum marks:** 75 **Pattern:** Fresh practice paper based on lab syllabus.

Part A - Answer all, 2 marks each

1. Define least count and zero error.

2. State Hooke law.

3. What is terminal velocity?

4. State Snell law.

5. What is diode knee voltage?

6. Write balance condition in meter bridge.

7. Mention two thermometer precautions.

8. Why is a current-limiting resistor used with diode?

Part B - Answer any six, 5 marks each

1. Explain screw gauge diameter measurement.

2. Describe parallelogram law experiment.

3. Explain simple pendulum method to find g .

4. Describe resonance column method.

5. Explain $u-v$ method for convex lens.

6. Verify Ohm law using $V-I$ graph.

7. Draw diode $V-I$ characteristics and find knee voltage.

8. Find specific resistance using meter bridge.

Part C - Answer any four, 10 marks each

1. With diagram, explain Vernier calipers experiment for volume measurement.

2. Explain Stoke law viscosity experiment with formula and precautions.

3. Explain flywheel experiment and energy idea.

4. Verify Snell law using glass slab/prism with ray diagram.

5. Verify laws of series and parallel resistances with circuits.

6. Explain potentiometer method for emf comparison/internal resistance.

Complete Model Answers

Answer guide with expected points, formula/diagram hints, precautions and common mistakes.

General answer format

Every model answer should contain definition/principle, labelled diagram or circuit, formula with variables, procedure, observation table, calculation, result with unit, precautions and common mistakes.

Answer 1: Vernier calipers: define least count, zero correction, jaws, $MSR + VSR \times LC$, volume formula and precautions.

Answer 2: Screw gauge: pitch, LC, $PSR + CSR \times LC$, ratchet use and zero correction.

Answer 3: Hooke law: F proportional to x , plot graph, slope gives k , stay within elastic limit.

Answer 4: Stoke law: terminal velocity, eta formula, central fall, avoid bubbles, use terminal region.

Answer 5: Optics: draw normal/rays, use lens equation or Snell ratio, avoid parallax and thick lines.

Answer 6: Electrical: show correct ammeter/voltmeter connection, polarity, current limiting, graph slope and loose-contact troubleshooting.

Answer 7: Meter bridge/potentiometer: null method, balance condition, jockey precautions and connection polarity.

References

- Text Book of Physics for Class XI & XII (Part-I, Part-II), N.C.E.R.T., Delhi.
- Comprehensive Practical Physics, Vol. I & II, J. N. Jaiswal, Laxmi Publications (P) Ltd., New Delhi.
- Practical Physics by C. L. Arora, S. Chand & Company Ltd.

Online resources: Supplied source mentions e-books/e-tools/learning physics software/YouTube videos/websites etc. without specific URLs. Official references with exact URLs were not specified in supplied source; use trusted institutional resources as supplementary learning links.

